

Miguel I. Puertas

Ph.D. Candidate in Finance, Terry College of Business, University of Georgia

Expected Graduation: May 2027

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Empirical asset pricing, market microstructure, financial intermediaries, valuation, and information asymmetry in financial markets.

WORKING PAPERS

“Insider Alpha: Evidence from Private Foundation Portfolios,” with Zhongjin Lu

Job Market Paper

- American Finance Association (AFA) Annual Meeting, 2027 (scheduled)
- Financial Management Association (FMA) Annual Meeting, 2026 (scheduled)

Abstract: Using a novel dataset of private foundation returns and security-level holdings, we show that size and alternative-asset tilt generate no alpha once return smoothing is accounted for. Alpha is concentrated among foundations founded by hedge fund (HF) principals. Consistent with insider advantage rather than transferable skill, HF-affiliated foundations’ outperformance arises primarily from highly concentrated portfolios; across HF- and private-equity-affiliated foundations, holdings concealed from regulators predict alpha more strongly than disclosed ones, related investments predict alpha whereas unrelated investments do not, and alpha persists after founders retire. These findings challenge the view that alternative alpha is available to investors with sufficient capital and patience.

“Cumulative Fee Neglect and Brokerage Choice,” with Gregory Eaton and Steven Malliaris.

- Eastern Finance Association (EFA) Annual Meeting, 2026

“The Vanishing Deal: How the Changing M&A Market Challenges What We Know About Acquisitions,” with Jeff Netter, Annette Poulsen, and Mike Stegemoller.

- RCF-ECGI Corporate Finance and Governance Conference, 2026 (scheduled)
- Mergers & Acquisitions Research Centre Conference (MARC), 2025
- Previously circulated as “Looking Beyond the Bigs”

“Information Asymmetry Among Investors,” with Corbin Fox and Harrison Ham.

WORK IN PROGRESS

“Zooming in on Insider Trading,” with Gregory Eaton and Andriy Shkillo.

- Grant: Business, Systems, and Technology Innovation Seed Grant (\$19,500), University of Georgia, 2025

“Repurchase Pressure in Interval Funds,” sole-authored.

- Financial Management Association (FMA) New Ideas Session, 2026 (scheduled)

“Talking Before Trading,” with Anthony Waikel.

- Financial Management Association (FMA) New Ideas Session, 2026 (scheduled)

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2027

American Finance Association (AFA) Annual Meeting (scheduled)

2026

Financial Management Association (FMA) Annual Meeting (scheduled)

7th Annual RCF-ECGI Corporate Finance and Governance Conference (scheduled)

Eastern Finance Association (EFA) Annual Meeting ($\times 2$)

Atlanta Finance Workshop*

The University of Auckland*

Clemson University*

University of Georgia*

2025

Annual Mergers & Acquisitions Research Centre Conference (MARC)*

Southern Finance Association (SFA) Annual Meeting

University of Louisville*

2024

UGA Football Conference Early Ideas Session*

* indicates presentations by coauthors.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record — University of Georgia

Behavioral Finance (upper-level undergraduate) — 4.81 / 5.00* Fall 2023

Investment Management (upper-level undergraduate) — 4.84 / 5.00* Spring 2025

Financial Management (undergraduate, online)[†] Summer 2025 & 2026

* *Instructor rating: mean response to “Overall, the instructor was effective at teaching the subject matter.”*

[†] *Asynchronous online section taught using course materials, lecture videos, and assessments developed by the senior course coordinator.*

Teaching Assistant — University of Georgia

Ph.D. Course: Empirical Research in Investments (Prof. Zhongjin (Gene) Lu) Fall 2024

MBA Course: Financial Management (Prof. Annette B. Poulsen) Fall 2025

Undergraduate Course: Capitalism (Prof. Jeffry M. Netter) Fall 2025

Undergraduate Course: Applied Corp. Finance (Prof. Xu Tian) Spring 2024 & 2026

RESEARCH TRAINING

Summer Microstructure School (Thierry Foucault and Albert J. Menkveld) 2026

Python, Big Data and Machine Learning Summer Bootcamp (Robbie Moon) 2023

AWARDS AND HONORS

Business, Systems, and Technology Innovation Seed Grant (\$19,500)	2025
Excellence in Teaching Award Nominee, University of Georgia	2025
Outstanding Teaching Assistant, University of Georgia	2025
Graduate Student Assistantship, The University of Southern Mississippi	2017
Outstanding Finance Student, William Carey University	2016
NAIA Scholar-Athlete	2016

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Financial Reporting Analyst, Wise PLC, Tampa, FL	2017 – 2022
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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Finance, University of Georgia	2022 – 2027 (expected)
M.S. in Finance, University of South Florida	2022
M.B.A., The University of Southern Mississippi	2017
– Graduate Student Researcher, Department of Finance	
B.S. in Finance (Cum Laude), William Carey University	2016
– Student-Athlete, Varsity Soccer (athletic scholarship)	

BACKGROUND AND PERSONAL

Began undergraduate studies at Universidad Carlos III de Madrid (Spain)
Former semi-professional soccer player (Wisconsin)
Youth professional soccer player (Madrid, Spain)
Alto saxophone player since age 12
Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent)

REFERENCES

Zhongjin (Gene) Lu (Chair)
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University of Georgia
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Gregory W. Eaton
*Bradford McFadden Professor of Personal Financial
Management and Associate Professor*
University of Georgia
✉ geaton@uga.edu

Annette B. Poulsen
*Augustus H. “Billy” Sterne Professor of Banking
and Finance, Josiah Meigs Distinguished Teaching
Professor and Professor*
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